

Unit 2: Understanding and written response

IAS compulsory unit

Externally assessed

2.1 Unit content

In this unit, students will develop their listening, reading and writing skills in Spanish, in relation to the four general topic areas (GTAs):

- Youth matters
- Lifestyle, health and fitness
- Environment and travel
- Education and employment.

The grammar list provided in *Appendix 6* illustrates the level required for this qualification.

What students need to learn

Students will learn to recognise and use the Spanish language in a variety of contexts and in relation to a prescribed range of general topic areas (GTAs):

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

1 Youth matters

- Family relationships and friendships
- Peer pressure and role models
- Music and fashion
- Technology and communication

2 Lifestyle, health and fitness

- Food and diet
- Sport and exercise
- Health issues
- Urban and rural life

3 Environment and travel

- Tourism, travel and transport
- Natural disasters and weather
- Climate change and its impact
- Energy, pollution and recycling

General topic areas (GTAs)

Subtopics

4 Education and employment

- Education systems and types of schooling
- Pupil/student life
- Volunteering and internships
- Jobs and unemployment

2.2 Assessment information

- This unit assesses listening, reading and writing skills.
- First assessment: June 2017.
- The assessment is 2 hours and 30 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 90 marks.
- There are three sections: Section A assesses listening skills; Section B assesses reading and grammar skills and Section C assesses writing skills.
- Sections A and B consist of eight questions. Section C consists of one extended-writing task.
- Each question is set on any of the four general topic areas (GTAs).
- Students must answer all questions.
- The unit will include multiple-choice, short-open and open-response questions and one extended-writing question.
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.